



Knock on G2/G2 Flex

The KnockCode feature will be included on the G2 and G2 Flex models <http://dgit.in/LGKnock>



SpaceX Dragon launch

The Dragon spacecraft will be launched on March 30 to resupply the ISS <http://dgit.in/DragonLaunch>

- A highly crucial duty of the administrator is planning the backup and recovery of the database. He should strive for high availability of data.
- Providing information that the user wants (and in the required format) is one of the main responsibilities of the database administrator. In order to fulfil this duty, s/he must integrate various software tools with the database system.
- They understand the client's requirements and interact with the design team to create a database as per the former's needs. The DBA must have good communication skills to understand what the client wants and convey it to the designers.
- They assist the end users (the clients) in using the system.
- Database administrators also manage metadata, which is the information about the database itself, rather than the data that it contains. DBAs have complete access to metadata, allowing them to change the database design.
- Administrators are superusers of the database, which means that they have full access to all the data and the authority to change it. They should exercise this privilege with utmost care and precaution.
- In a team of DBAs, s/he must act as a mentor to those in the lower levels of hierarchy.

Academic requirements & certifications

To embark on a career as a database administrator, a Bachelor's or Master's degree in Computer Science or Information Technology or BCA/MCA is a good place to start. Some employers may require a Master's in Business Administration (MBA). The industry always requires people who understand both, marketing and IT.

"A DBA needs to have a solid foundation of engineering, but he would need to take additional certifications which will help him learn a specific technology, like MongoDB or Oracle", Kamal shares. If you want to specialise in database technologies, various certification programs such as OC Certification (Oracle Certifica-

tion Program <http://dgit.in/1ghJxBA>) and MCDBA (Microsoft Certified Database Administrator <http://dgit.in/1iJRBu6>) can help you.

You can do certification courses in Database Management, and related fields from NIIT or other such reputed institutes. Based on your circumstances, you can opt for either correspondence or full-time certification programmes with flexible timings. Go to <http://dgit.in/1dwr5iV> to make your decision on a course easier.

Although a formal degree in computer science is not required to perform this job, most companies hire professionals with

manage. With global outsourcing, it's rare for a DBA to work in a 9-5 job, in India in particular. Avinash, a Lead Oracle DBA himself, says that "handling databases is a 24x7 job. You can look forward to shift work and support on call if needed. You might even have to work weekends".

The remuneration

Income is usually a major factor in choosing a career. While Digit advocates doing what you love and loving what you do, we all want to be paid well in our jobs. Unfortunately, in our country, database administrators aren't paid as well as in



RDBMS with tables

comparatively advanced degrees and specialisation, with their pay scales adjusted accordingly. Low-level jobs that don't require formal education are outsourced and don't pay well.

What to study?

When selecting courses during your degree go for Data Structures, Database Management, Data Warehousing, Algorithms, Operating Systems and Operations Research, which teach students complex decision rules and their application on real data sets. Also, advanced courses in Statistics may also be useful in data analytics. Apart from all these, a DBA must have sound understanding of basic programming concepts and familiarity with related technologies, mainly Java (JDeveloper, J2EE, Apache).

Expected working hours

As a database administrator, your working hours depend on the type of systems you'll

developed nations such as the U.S. Talk about the hardships of a developing nation.

According to Kamal Brar, your salary is subject to your place of graduation as well as the type of organisation you joined. A research report (<http://dgit.in/1di9tgc>) by PayScale, informs that a database administrator in India earns anywhere between ₹1.8 lakhs p.a. to ₹9.8 lakhs p.a., if you're working with companies such as Accenture, Cognizant, Infosys, TCS, IBM, Wipro, Tech Mahindra and the likes.

In the end, it's a competitive market so a highly inclusive skill set coupled with years of work experience will ensure higher pay and likelihood of being hired. In today's IT sector, nothing is isolated and you must have comprehensive knowledge about all the related fields. Here, we're not implying that you should be a jack of all trades and master of none. Your skill set should fundamentally revolve around databases.